



1. PURPOSE:

The Purpose to establish a fair, transparent, impartial, and confidential process for receiving, evaluating, investigating, resolving, and communicating complaints and appeals related to the certification activities.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all records related to certification activities. Complaints regarding the CB's certification activities and appeals against certification decisions.

2.1 Application for Certification

2.2 Certified Client

2.3 Interested Party

2.4 Certification Body personnel

3. **REFERENCES:** BVSPL-QM-01 Quality Manual **and** Corrective and preventive actions

4. RESPONSIBILITY:

Technical Manager/ Quality Manager shall be responsible for implementing this procedure.

5. DESCRIPTION:

5.1 Complaint: Expression of dissatisfaction, other than appeal, by any person or organization to a certification body, relating to the activities of that certification body, or to a certified client, where a response is expected.

A complaint may be made by any interested party (e.g., a client, customer, regulator, or member of the public) regarding: The certification body's services or conduct.

5.1.1 Complaint Process:

Step 1: Complaints may be received through: Email, Website, Letter, Telephone, in person

Step 2: Minimum information required: Name, Contact Details, Nature of Complaint, Supporting Evidence

Step 3: The complaint shall be acknowledged within **5 working days**.

Step 4: Review: The Quality Manager/ Technical Manager determines whether: The complaint relates to CB activities and certified Client.

Step 5: Investigation: The Quality Manager/ Technical Manager are assigned to Collect evidence, Review audit records and verify facts.

Step 6: Decision: An impartial individual or committee not involved in the original matter shall make or approve the decision.

Possible outcomes include: Complaint partially upheld, Complaint rejected., Further investigation required.

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Step 6: Corrective Action: Ensuring that any appropriate correction and corrective action are taken.

Step 7: The complainant shall receive: Actions taken, Investigation and decision record and BV SPL shall give formal notice of the end of the complaints-handling process to the complainant.

Step 8: BV SPL shall discuss with both the **certified client** and the **complainant** before making any complaint information public.

5.2 Client Record:

Records on certified clients shall include the following:

5.2.1 application information and initial, surveillance and recertification audit reports;

5.2.2 certification agreement;

5.2.3 justification of the methodology used for sampling of sites, as appropriate;

5.2.4 Justification for auditor time determination (see 9.1.4);

5.2.5 Verification of correction and corrective actions;

5.2.6 Records of complaints and appeals, and any subsequent correction or corrective actions;

5.2.7 committee deliberations and decisions, if applicable;

5.2.8 documentation of the certification decisions;

5.2.9 certification documents, including the scope of certification with respect to product, process or service, as applicable;

5.2.10 related records necessary to establish the credibility of the certification, such as evidence of the competence of auditors and technical experts;

5.2.11 audit programmes.

5.2.12 BV SPL shall establish and maintain a documented process to ensure that all records related to applicants and certified clients are **securely maintained and kept confidential**.

5.3 Appeal: Request by the provider of the object of conformity assessment to the certification body for reconsideration by that body of a decision it has made relating to that object.

An appeal is submitted by an applicant or certified client who disagrees with a certification decision made by the Certification Body, such as: Refusal to grant certification, Suspension or withdrawal of certification.

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	Procedure- Complaints and Appeals Process

5.3.1 **Appeals Process:** BVSPL Shall have a documented process to receive, evaluate and make decisions on appeals.

8. Record:

Document Name	Responsibility	Period
BVSPL-A-26 Complaint / Appeal – Technical Investigation Report	QM/TM	3 YEARS
BVSPL-A-13 Complaint/Appeals/Concern/ Registration Form	QM/TM	3 YEARS

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